

Classroom SEL pack, a week on teamwork, ages 3 to 7

Friendship Bridge

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Build a bridge together	Each partner tries building a bridge across the gap alone: one with only sticks, one with only string. Then build one together using both. Test it with a toy figure. Talk…	Page 8
Day 5 Good idea spotting	Good idea spotting, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Problem Solving and Innovating, Belonging and Contributing, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours, Self-Regulation and Well-Being

Materials

The book (or the class screen), craft sticks or twigs, rubber bands or string, a tray of water, small toy figures

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What animals are these? What are they building? Ask: Have you ever had a different idea from a friend? What happened? Take a few answers. Lace your fingers together and say ‘Together, we can do more.’ Ask children to listen for those words.

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	The giant strawberry bush across the river.	What do Venny and Sammy want?	the strawberries, to cross the river
4		Logs or branches? Why couldn’t Venny and Sammy agree at first?	Venny wants strong logs, Sammy wants light branches
6	Venny’s logs float away.	What went wrong with Venny’s bridge?	the logs were too heavy, they floated away
7	Sammy’s bridge collapses with a crack.	What went wrong with Sammy’s bridge?	the branches were too weak and wobbly
8	‘Your idea didn’t work!’	Is blaming each other helping?	no, they are both grumpy and wet
10	Each names what is good in the other’s idea.	What was good about Venny’s idea? What was good about Sammy’s?	logs are strong; branches are light and bendy
11	Tie the logs with branches!	How did they put their ideas together?	branches tie the logs, logs make it strong
13	They laugh and cheer as they work.	How does working together feel?	fun, faster, better

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don’t need every stop.

Handle with care: Neither friend is right or wrong. Keep the message that both ideas had something good. More notes on the “For every child” page.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

bridge

something you build to cross over water or a gap

Do it: make an arch with your arm

log

a big, heavy piece of a tree trunk

Do it: hold your arms out wide and heavy

branch

a thin, bendy part of a tree

Do it: wiggle one arm like a branch

argue

to disagree with cross words

Do it: put your hands on your hips and shake your head

together

with each other

Do it: lace your fingers together

Teamwork

The value in this book.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca



Together, we can do more.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



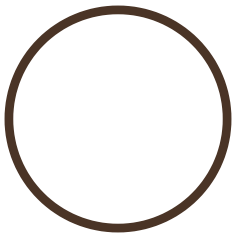
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

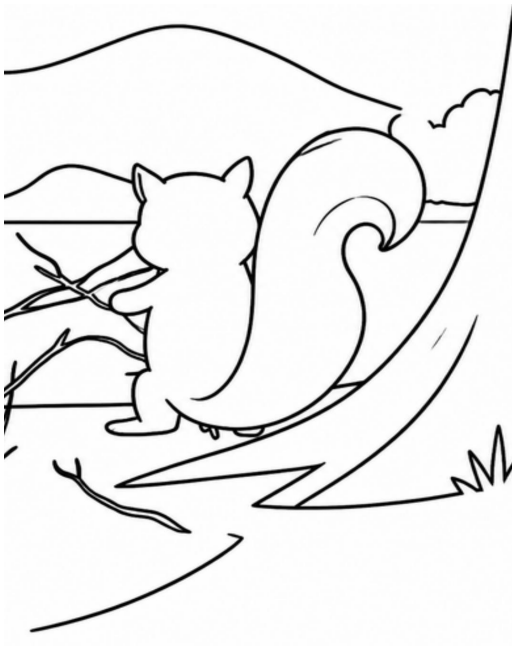
Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Build a bridge together

20 minutes, Pairs, Materials: Craft sticks, string or rubber bands, two books with a gap between

Each partner tries building a bridge across the gap alone: one with only sticks, one with only string. Then build one together using both. Test it with a toy figure. Talk about what worked.

Good idea spotting

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: Chart paper

Give a simple problem (‘How do we carry all the books?’). Take two different ideas. Ask the class to name one good thing about each idea, then find a way to combine them.

Float or sink

10 minutes, Small groups, Materials: A tray of water, twigs, small pieces of wood

Test which pieces float and which bend. Talk about why Venny’s logs floated away and Sammy’s branches snapped.

Science and nature corner

Beavers are expert builders. They cut down trees with their strong front teeth and use logs, branches and mud to build dams and lodges in rivers and ponds. The beaver is a national symbol of Canada. Squirrels have bushy tails that help them balance as they leap from branch to branch. In real life, wild strawberries grow as low plants, not tall bushes: the giant bush is make-believe.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why couldn't Venny and Sammy agree at first?

Look for: They each had a different idea: logs or branches.

2. What went wrong with each bridge when they built alone?

Look for: The logs floated away; the branches collapsed.

3. What was good about Venny's idea? What was good about Sammy's?

Look for: Logs are strong; branches are light and bendy.

4. When have you and a friend had different ideas? What did you do?

Look for: Any answer.

5. What could you build with someone else this week?

Look for: Any answer. Try one in the block corner.



The big line

"Together, we can do more."

The big idea: When we put our ideas together, we can do more than either of us could alone.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show teamwork this week.
Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show teamwork by

Name _____



I can show teamwork by

Name _____



I can show teamwork by

Name _____



I can show teamwork by

Name _____

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Problem Solving and Innovating	Belonging and Contributing	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Notes

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Science and place corner

The book's river has no name, so we picked Algonquin Park in Ontario. Beavers and red squirrels both live in its forests and lakes.



North American beaver

A beaver dam found in Alberta in 2007 is 850 metres long! Beavers had worked on it for years.



American red squirrel

A midden of cone scales can grow up to 12 metres across.

Algonquin Provincial Park, Ontario

Venny: Real beavers really are master builders, but they build dams and lodges, not bridges. Working together is real, though: a beaver family shares its home.

Sammy: Real red squirrels like to be alone and guard their food, so a squirrel teaming up with a beaver is a story idea. It makes the teamwork in the book even more special!

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/friendship-bridge

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Show a real stick and a real twig for ‘log’ and ‘branch’. Teach ‘Together!’ with a hand-lacing gesture.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 4, 7 and 11). This book has 17 spreads with short text on each, so it reads quickly.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children draw a plan for a bridge before building, label the parts, and explain whose idea each part came from.

Handle with care

Neither friend is right or wrong. Keep the message that both ideas had something good.

Real-life safety: never build or cross homemade bridges over real rivers. Keep bridge-building to tables and sandboxes.

The grass bridge of Peru is a living Quechua tradition. Share it simply and respectfully.

Where this value comes from

This story doesn’t come from one culture. In the Andes of Peru, four Quechua communities still work together every year to rebuild a bridge out of grass, twisting many thin cords into one great rope: a real bridge that can only be made together.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read Friendship Bridge, a story about teamwork. Venny the beaver and Sammy the squirrel each try to build a bridge their own way and fail, then put their ideas together and build the strongest bridge in the forest. At home, build something together, like a tower, a fort or a meal, and use one idea from each person. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Le Pont de l'Amitié, une histoire sur le travail d'équipe. Venny le castor et Sammy l'écureuil essaient chacun de construire un pont à leur façon, échouent, puis réunissent leurs idées et construisent le pont le plus solide de la forêt. À la maison, construisez quelque chose ensemble, une tour, une cabane ou un repas, en utilisant une idée de chaque personne. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre el trabajo en equipo. Venny, el castor, y Sammy, la ardilla, intentan construir un puente cada uno a su manera y fracasan; luego juntan sus ideas y construyen el puente más fuerte del bosque. En casa, construyan algo juntos, una torre, un fuerte o una comida, usando una idea de cada persona. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte über Teamarbeit gelesen. Der Biber Venny und das Eichhörnchen Sammy versuchen jeder auf seine Art, eine Brücke zu bauen, und scheitern; dann legen sie ihre Ideen zusammen und bauen die stärkste Brücke des Waldes. Bauen Sie zu Hause gemeinsam etwas, einen Turm, eine Höhle oder ein Essen, und nehmen Sie von jeder Person eine Idee. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sul lavoro di squadra. Venny, il castoro, e Sammy, lo scoiattolo, provano ognuno a costruire un ponte a modo suo e falliscono; poi uniscono le idee e costruiscono il ponte più solido del bosco. A casa, costruite qualcosa insieme, una torre, una capanna o un pasto, usando un'idea di ciascuno. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Teamwork: I can

- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Teamwork: I can

- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Teamwork: I can

- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Teamwork: I can

- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .



How do I feel about it?

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca



Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

Friendship Bridge

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: teamwork.

For use in your own home. Please don’t share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

When we put our ideas together, we can do more than either of us could alone.

The big line

“Together, we can do more.”

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
bridge	something you build to cross over water or a gap	make an arch with your arm
log	a big, heavy piece of a tree trunk	hold your arms out wide and heavy
branch	a thin, bendy part of a tree	wiggle one arm like a branch
argue	to disagree with cross words	put your hands on your hips and shake your head
together	with each other	lace your fingers together

A gentle note

Neither friend is right or wrong. Keep the message that both ideas had something good.

Real-life safety: never build or cross homemade bridges over real rivers. Keep bridge-building to tables and sandboxes.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Venny

North American beaver

A beaver who learns that building together is better



Sammy

American red squirrel

Venny's friend, who helps build the bridge

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

How did they feel?

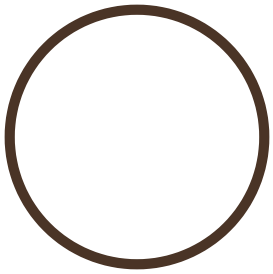
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

The giant strawberry bush across the river.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

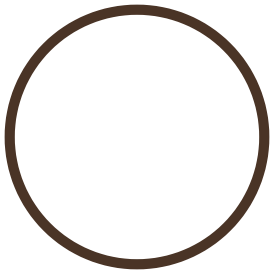


Moment 2

‘Your idea didn’t work!’

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

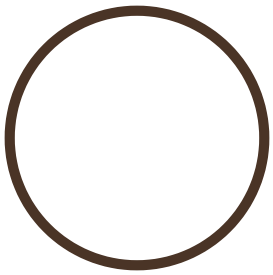


Moment 3

They laugh and cheer as they work.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

bridge something you build to cross over water or a gap

bridge bridge

log a big, heavy piece of a tree trunk

log log

branch a thin, bendy part of a tree

branch branch

Venny the hero of the story

Venny Venny

Write your name

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Draw your own story

Venny showed teamwork. Draw a time when you showed teamwork too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Build a bridge together

You need: Craft sticks, string or rubber bands, two books with a gap between

Each partner tries building a bridge across the gap alone: one with only sticks, one with only string. Then build one together using both. Test it with a toy figure. Talk about what worked.

Build a bridge together

Use blocks, sticks or paper to build a bridge with a friend. Who did which job?

Beaver chew

Crunch a carrot and think about a beaver's strong teeth. Theirs never stop growing!

Cone count

Collect pine cones on a walk. How many could you store, like a red squirrel?

Draw what you made

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

The real animals

The animals in Friendship Bridge are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Venny

North American beaver

A beaver dam found in Alberta in 2007 is 850 metres long! Beavers had worked on it for years.



Sammy

American red squirrel

A midden of cone scales can grow up to 12 metres across.

Story or real?

Real beavers really are master builders, but they build dams and lodges, not bridges. Working together is real, though: a beaver family shares its home.

Where they really live

The book's river has no name, so we picked Algonquin Park in Ontario. Beavers and red squirrels both live in its forests and lakes.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/friendship-bridge

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What animals are these? What are they building?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 1

Why couldn't Venny and Sammy agree at first?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 2

What went wrong with each bridge when they built alone?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 3

What was good about Venny's idea? What was good about Sammy's?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 4

When have you and a friend had different ideas? What did you do?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 5

What could you build with someone else this week?

Friendship Bridge, talk card 6

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca



Teamwork hero

This is to say that

_____

showed teamwork, just like Venny.

_____ _____

Signed Date

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca